support for the *contras* in Nicaragua, increased the tensions between the superpowers. Arms race resumed and arms control talks were ruptured. The Soviets boycotted the 1984 Olympic Games in Los Angeles. Under such 'hot' circumstances, Reagan proclaimed his famous doctrine, generally known as the **Reagan Doctrine.** He pledged US support to anticommunists insurgents to overthrow Soviet-supported governments in Afghanistan, Angola and Nicaragua.

President Reagan vowed to take the wars to the space. His **Strategic Defence Initiative (SDI),** dubbed **Star Wars**, had grave consequences on the superpower relations. The SDI was a research programme designed to explore opportunities of space-based defences against ballistic missiles. This was not welcomed by the Soviets and they took the threats seriously and it dampened the relations. Ultimately, the SDI did not materialize and later on was abandoned by Reagan's successors. Nevertheless, the situations became explosive and more complex because of the moves and countermoves of the superpowers.

Though the situation became alarming it did not explode primarily with the ascendancy of Mikhail Gorbachev as the President of Soviet Union in 1985. His *new thinking* in foreign policy and his domestic reforms (*glasnost* and *perestroika*) marked a new beginning in the East–West relations. Therefore, there was again easing of tensions between the two superpowers, which was followed by what is known as **New Détente** and ultimately the **end of Cold War.**